

Final Report – Project Assessment Criteria- 3rd Year Individual Projects (ECM3175)

Section	Excellent (>80%)	Very Good (70-80%)	Good (55-69%)	Satisfactory (40-54%)	Poor (below 40%)
Abstract (5 Marks) - Background to project - Project aim - Methodologies used - Main outcomes - Conclusions	Very well written, accurately and concisely captures all the essential aspects of the project, methodology, outcomes and issues	Reasonably well written and captures most of the essential elements of the project, methodology, outcomes and issues	Adequately written and captures most elements methodology, outcomes and issues though missing some information	Poorly written and does not clearly convey information concerning project topic, method, issues and/or outcomes	Badly written and/or does not summarise the project topic and its outcomes
Introduction and background (5 Marks) - What - Why - How - Aim - Objectives	- Thorough and in-depth understanding of the background - Clear, logical and crisp overview of the problem being addressed - Aim and objectives are precise, outlining clearly the what, why and how without leaving room for ambiguities	- Good, consistent knowledge and understanding of the background - Logical and unambiguous overview of the problem being addressed - Clear, well-defined aim and objectives	- Sound, routine knowledge of the problem being addressed - An appropriate overview of the problem being addressed but with minor shortcomings - Aim and objectives are stated but with minor ambiguities	- Broadly accurate understanding of the problem being addressed - Some elements missing and flaws evident - Aim and objectives are given but need much sharpening	- Fails to demonstrate a basic understanding of the problem - Reader left confused about the focus of project. - Lacks/badly written aim and objectives
Literature review (15 Marks) - What has been done before - How it shapes your project - Good referencing	- Exceptionally wide range of relevant literature used critically to inform argument, balance discussion and/or inform problem-solving. - Consistently accurate use of references. - Shows follow up of most recent advances	- Critical engagement with appropriate reading. - Knowledge of research-informed literature. - Consistently accurate use of references.	- Knowledge of literature beyond core text(s). - Literature used accurately but descriptively. - Referencing generally sound.	- Some evidence of reading, with superficial linking to given text(s). - Referencing is largely consistent, but with some weaknesses.	- Evidence of little reading and/or indiscriminate use of sources. - Very few references and/or badly cited.
Methodology and theory (20 Marks) Elaboration of project-relevant key concepts identified in literature review	- Excellent description of the methodology and/or experimental/design procedure - Demonstrates a thorough and in-depth knowledge and understanding of concepts and theories that goes beyond expectations for this level - Extensive, relevant and logically organised - Shows a good degree of originality/creativity with notable progress beyond background reading - Clear evidence of significant progress towards objectives	- Very good description of the methodology and/or experimental/design procedure - Good consistent knowledge and understanding of concepts and theories - Relevant and logically organised - Shows some degree of originality with clear and useful progress beyond background reading - Clear evidence of good progress towards stated objectives	- Good description of the methodology and/or experimental/design procedure with minor flaws - Sound understanding of concepts and theories - Acceptable coverage - Shows reasonable progress beyond background reading - Evidence of an acceptable level of progress towards stated objectives	- Appropriate description of the methodology and/or experimental/design procedure with evident of flaws - Broadly accurate knowledge and understanding of the concepts and theories - Limited coverage - Shows limited progress beyond background reading - Some evidence of progress towards stated objectives	- Incomplete/incorrect description of the methodology and experimental/design procedure - Lack of understanding of concepts and theories - Shows no progress beyond background reading - No evidence of progress towards objectives

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Experimental work /analytical investigation/design (20 Marks) - Analysis, experiments or design (hardware, software, procedures) - Design (of equipment or procedure)	- Excellent description of how the methodology/experimental work is employed/conducted - Can collect and interpret appropriate data/ information and undertake research tasks with autonomy and exceptional success.	- Good description of how the methodology/experimental work is employed/conducted - Can collect and interpret appropriate data and successfully undertake research tasks with a degree of autonomy.	- An acceptable description of the methodology/experimental work is employed/conducted - Can collect and interpret appropriate data/ information and undertake straightforward research tasks with external guidance.	- Limited description of the methodology/experimental work is employed/conducted - Some evidence of ability to collect appropriate data/information and undertake straightforward research tasks with external guidance.	- Poor presentation of the methodology/experimental work is employed/conducted - Limited evidence of skills in the range identified for the assessment at this level. - Significant weaknesses evident.
Presentation of experimental or analytical results/description of final constructed product (15 Marks) Exposition of outcomes of the project in the form of a finished product, set of experimental results or outputs from computational or theoretical work	- Neat, logical and crisp presentation of results as evidence of thorough and detailed work - Excellent plots, tables, drawings presented creatively with clear labelling and clear references from text - Outcomes self-evident from the presentation without having to explore through text - Results show work beyond expectations at this level.	- Clear, unambiguous presentation of results as evidence of a good piece of technical work - Neat plots, tables, drawings with clear labelling and clear references from text - Outcomes self-evident from the presentation without having to explore through text	- Technically correct presentation of results but with minor shortcomings - Good legible plots, tables, drawings that are neatly linked from the text but with minor flaws - Major outcomes are largely evident from the presentation	- Results are given but with some evident gaps - Purpose of some plots, tables, drawings etc. is not clear - Presentation is not coherent - Some conclusions are brought out	- Few results presented - Fundamental technical issues present - Drawings, tables, plots hard to read - Inadequate information to substantiate conclusions
Discussion and conclusions (10 Marks) - Description of what has been learnt from experimental/analytical work or design - Distillation of important findings and their significance - Specific observations to inform future research	- Excellent discussion that distils new knowledge from results - A concise set of statements of convincing conclusions - Clearly defines foundations made for future research or product development - Conclusions demonstrate novel and publishable quality work	- Technically sound discussion highlighting findings from this study with well-balanced arguments. - Arguments generally logical, coherently expressed, well organised and supported. - Concise set of statements outlining sound conclusions. - Clear set of observations to inform future research.	- Good discussion highlighting the important findings but with minor weaknesses. - An emerging awareness of different stances and ability to use evidence to support a coherent argument. - Broadly valid conclusions.	- Sense of argument emerging though not completely coherent. - Some evidence to support views, but not always consistent. - Some relevant conclusions.	- For the most part descriptive with no clarity. - Important results not highlighted and views/findings sometimes illogical or contradictory - Generalisations/statements made with limited evidence. - Conclusions lack relevance and/or validity.
Project management, consideration of relevant sustainability, ethics, commercial or arising intellectual property and health and safety issues where appropriate, overall presentation throughout report (10 Marks) - Procedures and systems for project management - Sustainability/H&S as appropriate	- Very well defined how the project was managed. - Shows excellent awareness and relevance of health and safety and ethics issues, - Excellent awareness of relevant commercial or arising intellectual property issues - Demonstrates a thorough understanding of sustainability issues and their relevance, - Excellent level of English	- Clearly defined how the project was managed, - Shows awareness and relevance of health and safety and relevant commercial or arising intellectual property and ethics issues, - Demonstrates full understanding of sustainability issues and their relevance, - Few to no mistakes - High standard of English	- Sound overall management of project with minor shortcomings - Sufficient coverage of health and safety, ethics, relevant commercial or arising intellectual property and sustainability issues but few elements missing - Good level of English with few minor spelling and grammatical errors	- Acceptable overall level of management however with evident flaws - Some coverage of health and safety, ethics, relevant commercial or arising intellectual property and sustainability issues with some elements missing - Readable but contains some typos and grammatical errors	- Little clarity on what the student did - Unconvincing management strategy - Does not cover relevant health and safety, ethics, commercial or arising intellectual property and sustainability issues - Difficult to follow with lots of typos and grammatical mistakes